



VIBEHACK LONDON

2026 PARTICIPANT HANDBOOK

BUILD. DEMO. SHIP.

Dates	6-7 June 2026
Venue	1-19 Torrington Place, London, WC1E 7HB
Format	24-hour AI hackathon (no overnight access)
Submission deadline	12:00, Sunday 7 June 2026

Keep this handbook open during the hackathon.

1. QUICK START

The essential information you need before building

Most Important Deadline

SUBMISSION DEADLINE

Complete your main Devpost submission by 12:00 on Sunday 7 June 2026. Submit early, keep every link accessible, and test your demo before judging.

Your Five Essential Actions

1. Choose one main track: Health Impact or Vibe with Zymix.
2. Build one working AI product and complete one main Devpost submission.
3. Prepare one clear 3-minute live demo. You do not need separate pitches for different awards.
4. Add all required special-award links to Devpost, and upload the Ortie Package separately to Orbit where applicable.
5. Stay at your assigned table during judging and be ready to show the product working.

Key Links

- [GLM / Z.ai event resources](https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1rmzA3Gvu_Q53EyPytF2R-b4APD7Zulp3) — https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1rmzA3Gvu_Q53EyPytF2R-b4APD7Zulp3
- [Manus event registration](https://manus.im/live-events/EVENT-4022) — <https://manus.im/live-events/EVENT-4022>
- [Fotor award guidance](https://docs.google.com/document/d/1FnOiqmQWjoWLAktPTt81D0cepQYIE8PdJJprY0vURo0/edit?usp=sharing) — <https://docs.google.com/document/d/1FnOiqmQWjoWLAktPTt81D0cepQYIE8PdJJprY0vURo0/edit?usp=sharing>
- [Ortie instructions](https://orbit24.uk/ortie.md) — <https://orbit24.uk/ortie.md>
- [Participant Discord](https://discord.gg/WQBSEp8ZW) — <https://discord.gg/WQBSEp8ZW>

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2. EVENT ACCESS AND CONDUCT

Arrival, venue rules, safety and expected behaviour

Arrival and Access

- Check-in is from 09:30 to 10:30 on Saturday 6 June.
- The opening ceremony and challenge announcements begin at 10:30.
- Participants arriving after 12:00 may be refused entry and registration because of venue capacity and UCL security requirements.
- This is a participant-only event. Visitors and spectators are not permitted.
- Bring valid identification and keep your event identification or team card with you.
- A team without the required team card may not be able to present in final judging.

Venue Rules

Only registered participants, judges, invited guests, sponsors, volunteers, organisers and authorised UCL staff may enter the event space.

Follow all instructions from organisers, UCL staff and security. Anyone carrying out unauthorised promotional, commercial, speculative or disruptive activity may be asked to leave.

SAFETY AND SUPPORT

For urgent support, speak to an organiser or volunteer immediately. Do not confront disruptive or unauthorised individuals yourself; the organising team will work with UCL Security.

Working Expectations

- Build during the official hackathon period and represent your work honestly.
- Respect other teams, mentors, volunteers, judges and venue staff.
- Do not interfere with another team's work, equipment, accounts or submissions.
- Keep walkways clear and follow room, fire-safety and capacity instructions.

Fire Safety and Emergency Exits

- A fire-safety briefing will be given during the opening ceremony. Please listen carefully and make sure you understand the evacuation procedure.
- Green safety signs indicate emergency exits and escape routes. Please familiarise yourself with the nearest emergency exit when you arrive, and keep all exits, corridors and evacuation routes clear at all times.
- If the fire alarm sounds, stop working immediately, leave the building calmly through the nearest safe exit, and follow the instructions of organisers, UCL staff and security. Do not stop to collect personal belongings, and do not re-enter the building until authorised to do so.

3. TEAMS AND MAIN TRACKS

Choose one track, one challenge direction and one working product

Team Rules

- Team size: 1-4 people.
- Recommended team size: 2-4 people.
- Solo builders are welcome and will be treated as a team of one.
- Prize eligibility is capped at four members per team.
- Each participant may join only one team.
- Each team must submit one main project and deliver one main demo.

Choose One Main Track

ONE MAIN TRACK ONLY

Your team must select either Track 1: Health Impact or Track 2: Vibe with Zymix. Your selected track determines the challenge, judging criteria and prizes for which your team is eligible.

- Track 1: Health Impact
- Track 2: Vibe with Zymix

Within your selected track, choose one main challenge direction and clearly identify it in your Devpost submission.

TRACK 1: HEALTH IMPACT

Build an AI-supported product that tackles a real health challenge in the UK

This track is about creating solutions that are practical, thoughtful and capable of improving how people experience health, care and prevention in everyday life.

Teams may choose one of the following challenge directions.

Challenge 1: Student Mental Health Support

Many university students struggle to access timely mental health support, while universities continue to face budget and capacity pressures. Some students actively seek help, but many suffer in silence and never reach support early enough.

YOUR CHALLENGE

Design an AI-supported solution that could be rolled out across universities to improve how students are identified, supported and guided to the right help.

Possible directions include:

- Triage and wellbeing check-ins
- NHS or university-service signposting
- Peer-support coordination
- Earlier identification of students who may be struggling but are not yet asking for help

Strong solutions will work alongside existing services rather than replace clinical care. The best submissions will show a strong understanding of both the student experience and the practical constraints universities face.

Challenge 2: Making NHS Admin Easier for Patients

For many patients, navigating NHS admin can be confusing, fragmented and stressful. Letters, appointments, referrals, forms, app notifications and follow-up instructions often feel inconsistent and hard to understand, especially for people already dealing with illness or uncertainty.

YOUR CHALLENGE

Design an AI-supported solution that helps patients understand, organise and act on the information they receive from the NHS.

Possible directions include:

- Preparing for appointments
- Summarising concerns before seeing a clinician
- Understanding clinic letters
- Completing forms
- Navigating referrals
- Knowing what to do while waiting for care

The strongest solutions will improve the patient experience while also reducing avoidable friction for NHS staff who currently have to explain, repeat and repair unclear processes.

Challenge 3: Prevention and Early Intervention

Many preventable health problems are only addressed once symptoms have worsened. The NHS wants to shift towards prevention and earlier action, but in practice many people delay seeking help, struggle to interpret symptoms or do not know what realistic next steps to take.

YOUR CHALLENGE

Build an AI-supported tool that helps people act earlier on their health.

Possible directions include:

- Risk understanding
- Symptom tracking
- Screening
- Community-care navigation
- Turning health data into practical next steps

Teams should focus on a specific preventable issue or intervention point and think carefully about why people delay action. The best solutions will avoid generic lifestyle advice and instead support realistic, specific action without creating unnecessary anxiety.

Challenge 4: Safer Maternity Care for High-Risk and Under-Heard Mothers

Pregnancy, birth and the postnatal period can involve fast-changing risks, but not all mothers are equally likely to be heard, understood or taken seriously when they raise concerns. In the UK, maternity safety is also shaped by inequality, including differences linked to ethnicity, language, communication barriers and access to care.

YOUR CHALLENGE

Design an AI-supported solution that helps pregnant people and new parents recognise concerns, explain symptoms clearly and find the right route to support.

Possible directions include:

- Plain-language explanations
- Multilingual support
- Appointment preparation
- Care navigation
- Symptom summaries for communication with midwives, GPs or other care teams

Strong solutions should support communication and navigation, not diagnose users or replace clinicians. The best submissions will show sensitivity to safety, inequality and trust.

Health Impact Submission Requirements

- Build a working prototype or demo within the hackathon period.
- Clearly explain the health problem being addressed.
- Show who the user is and why the problem matters.
- Explain how AI is being used in the product.
- Show why the solution is realistic, useful and different from what already exists.

Health Impact Judging Focus

- A clear and important health problem
- Strong understanding of the user group
- Thoughtful and appropriate use of AI
- Practical value in a real-world setting
- Clarity and quality of the demo
- Awareness of safety, trust and implementation limits

HEALTH-TRACK PRINCIPLE

AI should support users, professionals and existing services. It must not be presented as a replacement for clinical diagnosis, treatment or professional judgement.

Health Impact Prizes - Powered by Cursor

Place	Prize
1st Place	6 months of Cursor Ultra access
2nd Place	4 months of Cursor Ultra access
3rd Place	3 months of Cursor Ultra access

TRACK 2: VIBE WITH ZYMIX

Build an AI-native feature or mini-product for a Gen Z social app

Teams should download the app, experience it as real users, identify a genuine opportunity and ship a working prototype during the hackathon.

Teams may choose one of the following challenge directions.

Challenge 1: Social Vibe Tool

Can you use AI to help two strangers break the ice, or turn an ordinary conversation into something memorable?

YOUR CHALLENGE

Build something that improves the quality of connection. Do not simply add more buttons; create an interaction that makes people actually feel something.

Possible directions include:

- AI-powered conversation starters
- Real-time emotional-response tools
- Personalised social-style assistants
- Interaction mechanics that make people want to come back

The strongest solutions will show how AI creates a more natural, memorable or emotionally engaging interaction.

Challenge 2: Entertainment Mini

It does not need to be a full game. It just needs to be something people want to play again the moment it ends.

YOUR CHALLENGE

Create lightweight, social and instantly playable entertainment where AI is what makes the experience genuinely fun.

Possible directions include:

- AI-driven roleplay games between friends
- Real-time quizzes or challenges
- AI-generated co-creation experiences
- Tools that make any group chat instantly more alive

The strongest solutions will be easy to understand, quick to start and enjoyable to repeat.

Challenge 3: Coordination Helper

Forty messages in the group chat and still no decision made - this is one of the most universal pain points in Gen Z social life.

YOUR CHALLENGE

Use AI to simplify group decision-making and reduce the friction of getting people together.

Possible directions include:

- AI-assisted time and place decision tools
- One-tap event creation with smart reminders
- Multi-person preference aggregation and recommendations
- Tools that finally answer: "Where should we eat tonight?"

The strongest solutions will reduce discussion fatigue and help groups move quickly from conversation to action.

Challenge 4: Community Builder

Not the people an algorithm pushes at users - the people they actually want to know.

YOUR CHALLENGE

Use AI to help Zymix users discover genuinely like-minded communities and turn those connections into something real.

Possible directions include:

- Interest- and behaviour-based intelligent matching
- Tools for building a small community from scratch
- Mechanisms that bring out quieter members
- AI-driven onboarding or community-activation tools

The strongest solutions will demonstrate how AI supports genuine belonging rather than superficial engagement.

Vibe with Zymix Submission Requirements

- Download and register on the Zymix app before the event.
- Confirm that the app is available in your region.
- Experience the product as real users and identify a genuine opportunity before building.
- Use any suitable AI development tools, such as Cursor, Lovable, Bolt, Figma AI, Claude or others.
- Submit a live demo, a short product brief, an explanation of why the idea matters for Zymix users, and a description of which AI tools were used and how.

Vibe with Zymix Judging Focus

- Relevance to Zymix users
- Originality of the concept
- Quality of the user experience
- Clarity and polish of the demo
- Effective use of AI

Vibe with Zymix Prizes - Cash Awards

Place	Prize
1st Place	£1,000
2nd Place	£800
3rd Place	£500

4. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY AND TOOL SHOWCASES

Ownership, public submissions and featured user cases

Project Ownership

TEAMS RETAIN OWNERSHIP

Teams retain ownership of their projects. Sponsors do not automatically receive ownership or commercial usage rights.

Public Submission and Sharing

Devpost and GitHub submissions are public or open-source-oriented. Teams should therefore treat anything they submit as material that may be publicly visible, accessed or shared.

- Do not submit confidential, proprietary or commercially sensitive intellectual property.
- Only submit code, content, data, models, media and other materials that your team has the right to share.
- Do not include third-party confidential information, restricted datasets, private credentials or materials that breach another person's rights.
- Check the terms and visibility settings of the platforms and tools you use.

Work Created During the Hackathon

Projects should be substantially built during the official hackathon period. Teams may use existing tools, libraries, APIs, templates and lawful pre-existing components, but must represent their work honestly and clearly explain what was created during the event.

AI Tool User-Case Showcases

If your team uses AI tools provided or supported through the event - including Cursor, Manus, Fotor or GLM / Z.ai - your project or workflow may be selected as a featured user case, best-use-case example, event recap or community showcase.

OWNERSHIP REMAINS WITH THE TEAM

Being selected for a user-case showcase does not transfer ownership of the project. The team continues to own its work, subject to the public submission settings and platform terms it has accepted.

5. DEVPOST SUBMISSION

One main submission for your track and applicable special awards

Every team must complete one main project submission on Devpost. This is the submission used for your main track and for the Fotor and Manus special awards where relevant.

SUBMISSION DEADLINE

12:00, Sunday 7 June 2026. Submit before the deadline; late or inaccessible submissions may not be judged.

Your Devpost Entry Should Include

- Team name
- Team members
- Main track
- Selected challenge direction
- Project title
- Short product summary
- What you built
- Who it is for
- What problem it solves
- How AI was used
- Demo or deployed link
- GitHub or code link, if applicable
- Video demo, if available
- Special awards applied for
- Any required special-award links

Submission Quality Checks

- Open every link in a private or logged-out browser window.
- Make sure judges can access the product without requesting permission.
- Use clear names for links and files.
- Keep a backup recording or screenshots in case the live demo fails.
- Submit early enough to correct mistakes before the deadline.

6. SPECIAL AWARDS

Optional awards that use your same main project and demo

Special awards are optional. You may apply for more than one award when your project and workflow are genuinely relevant. You still give only one main demo pitch.

6.1 Fotor Vibe Marketing Award

Add your published Fotor community post or Fotor link to Devpost. The link must be real, accessible and connected to your final project. It may be checked after the event.

Prize Structure

- Two 1st-place winners: 6-month Fotor access.
- One 2nd-place winner: 3-month Fotor access.

Criterion	Weight	What judges will consider
Storytelling	40%	Do the visuals help people understand and remember the product?
Feature Completion	30%	Can judges see finished visual assets, campaign materials or Fotor output?
Business Awareness	30%	Does the work show awareness of branding, audience, positioning, marketing performance or commercial use?

The Fotor award will be judged mainly during offline table-side judging. Show or explain your Fotor output naturally during the 3-minute demo; judges are not expected to inspect every online link during the main judging window.

6.2 Manus Real-World Use Case Award

Add your published Manus link to Devpost. Be ready to explain briefly how Manus supported the project and to show the published link if a judge asks.

Prize Structure

- 1st place: 6 months Manus Max membership.
- 2nd place: 4 months Manus Max membership.
- 3rd place: 3 months Manus Max membership.

Criterion	Weight	What judges will consider
Use Case Clarity	40%	Is it clear what Manus was used for?
Practical Workflow Value	40%	Did Manus help the team research, plan, automate, prototype, coordinate or deliver faster?
Published Evidence Quality	20%	Is the published Manus link accessible, convincing and connected to the final project?

Manus credits and a two-day membership are available through the event registration page. Scan the QR code below to register.



manus.im/live-events/EVENT-4022

6.3 Z.ai x Orbit Builder Workflow Awards

Z.ai x Orbit awards are handled through Orbit, not through Devpost judging. Use Ortie during the hackathon and upload your final Ortie Package to Orbit.

How It Works

1. Open your coding agent or AI development tool.
2. Ask it to read and embody Ortie: <https://orbit24.uk/ortie.md>
3. Work as normal during the hackathon.
4. At the end, ask: "Ortie, capture my persona."
5. Answer any missing questions that Ortie asks.
6. Save or download the generated Orbit Package.
7. Upload the package to Orbit.

Z.ai is part of the event capture lens. Ortie will ask for missing Z.ai or GLM workflow details before generating the final package.

The Four Award Lenses

Four awards are available, with a £300 cash prize for each category (£1,200 total).

- **Best Product Integration — £300 cash prize:** Z.ai or GLM is meaningfully integrated into the final product, feature, backend, agent workflow or user-facing experience.

- **Best Workflow Use — £300 cash prize:** Z.ai or GLM meaningfully supported research, planning, coding, debugging, comparison, iteration or team workflow.
- **Best Real-World Potential — £300 cash prize:** The Z.ai or GLM-supported product or workflow demonstrates strong practical value beyond the hackathon.
- **Best Build-in-Public Story — £300 cash prize:** The team clearly captured how it built, which tools it used, what changed, what failed and what it learned.

BUILD NATURALLY

Do not force your project around these awards. Work seriously and capture your real process. Orbit will review the submitted package through the award lenses.

7. JUDGING FORMAT

Offline table-side judging with one clear demo

Judging is offline and table-side. Teams remain at their assigned tables while judges move between teams.

3 min Live demo	1 min Judge Q&A	1 min Scoring and movement
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Each team may present to around two or three judges. Use the same demo to explain the project clearly. You do not need separate pitches for your main track, Fotor, Manus or Z.ai x Orbit.

- If applying for Fotor, naturally show the relevant visual or campaign output.
- If applying for Manus, explain the workflow contribution and show the published link when asked.
- If applying for Z.ai x Orbit, submit the Orbit Package separately before the relevant deadline.
- Stay close to your table throughout the judging period.

8. MAIN TRACK JUDGING CRITERIA

Each project is scored from 1 to 5 across five dimensions

8.1 Health Impact

Criterion	Weight	What judges will consider
Health Problem Relevance	25%	Is the team addressing a clear, important and specific health challenge?
User Understanding & Equity	20%	Does the team understand the target group, context, barriers and inequalities?
Practical Real-World Value	20%	Could the solution realistically improve patient, student, clinician or public-health experience?
Appropriate and Safe Use of AI	20%	Is AI used thoughtfully, safely and appropriately, without replacing clinical judgement?
Clarity and Quality of Demo	15%	Is the demo clear, credible and easy to understand?

HEALTH-TRACK REMINDER

Be precise about the user, setting and limitations of the product. Do not make unsupported clinical claims, and do not present AI as a replacement for professional judgement.

8.2 Vibe with Zymix

Criterion	Weight	What judges will consider
Relevance to Zymix Users	25%	Does the project solve a genuine Gen Z pain point that current apps fail to solve, grounded in a real use case?
Originality of Concept	20%	Is the idea original, and does AI enable something meaningfully new?

Criterion	Weight	What judges will consider
Quality of User Experience	20%	Is the experience smooth, intuitive and well executed? Can users understand what to do without excessive explanation?
Clarity and Polish of Demo	15%	Does the demo communicate the core value professionally and show the product working?
Effective Use of AI	20%	Is AI a justified and essential driver of the experience rather than a decorative addition?

9. YOUR 3-MINUTE DEMO

Help judges understand the problem, see the product and remember why it matters

Your goal is not to explain every technical detail. Your goal is to help judges understand the problem, see the product working and remember why it matters.

Timing	Focus	What to cover
0:00-0:25	Problem and user	Who is this for, and what specific problem are you solving?
0:25-0:50	Core idea	What did you build, and why is it different or useful?
0:50-2:15	Live product demo	Show the working product as early as possible. Focus on the main user journey.
2:15-2:40	AI and workflow	Explain what AI does, why it is needed and which tools materially supported the build.
2:40-3:00	Impact and close	State the practical value, evidence of completion and the next logical step.

Demo Tips

- Open with the user problem, not a long team introduction.
- Show the working product within the first minute.
- Use one strong user journey rather than many unfinished features.
- Prepare seeded data, test accounts and tabs before judges arrive.
- Explain failure modes or limitations honestly when relevant.
- Finish on time and leave space for the judge's question.

10. RESOURCES AND FINAL CHECKLIST

Official links and the final pre-submission check

Official Resources

GLM / Z.ai event resources	https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1rmzA3Gvu_Q53EyPytF2R-b4APD7Zulp3
Fotor award guidance	https://docs.google.com/document/d/1FnOiqmQWjoWLAktPTt81D0cepQYIE8PdJJprY0vURo0/edit?usp=sharing
Ortie instructions	https://orbit24.uk/ortie.md
Manus event registration	https://manus.im/live-events/EVENT-4022
Participant Discord	https://discord.gg/WQBSEp8ZW

Final Checklist

- ☐ Our team has 1-4 eligible members.
- ☐ We selected exactly one main track and one challenge direction.
- ☐ Our product works in a repeatable demo flow.
- ☐ Our Devpost entry is complete and submitted before 12:00 Sunday.
- ☐ All demo, deployment, code and special-award links are accessible.
- ☐ Our Fotor link is included on Devpost, if applying.
- ☐ Our Manus link is included on Devpost, if applying.
- ☐ Our Ortie Package is uploaded separately to Orbit, if applying.
- ☐ We have prepared and timed one 3-minute demo.
- ☐ We know where our assigned table is and will stay nearby during judging.

FINAL REMINDER

Do not over-optimize for awards. Build the strongest project you can, show a real working experience, and explain clearly why it matters.